Payday Tides

Game budget | 16 October 2026

Current entry: The four-story browser prototype is complete and hosted on itch.io at no direct cash cost. No contractors, paid assets, model API calls, bank integrations, or paid hosting were purchased for this entry. Agent and owner time are separate from direct cash expenditure and are not represented as zero.

Optional future development scenario

The figures below describe a possible 12-month extension if a separate development offer is ever made and accepted. They are not a request for funding through this cash-category entry, an accepted contract, an incurred expense, or a promised delivery schedule. Rates and hours are planning assumptions, not invoices.

Item	Current prototype	Future extension (illustrative)
Design and engineering	$0 direct cash	$18,000 / 400 h
Financial education review	$0 direct cash	$3,375 / 45 h
Accessibility and usability	$0 direct cash	$2,000 / 40 h
Visual and sound refinement	$0 direct cash	$2,250 / 45 h
Localization preparation	$0 direct cash	$1,925 / 35 h
Hosting and contingency	$0 direct cash	$1,450 allowance
Total external cash / plan	$0 observed direct spend	$29,000 illustrative

What the extension would produce

Months 1-2: reviewed scenario curriculum and accessible design. Months 3-6: expanded browser alpha with new mechanics and transparent accounting. Months 7-9: two rounds of independent usability and learning tests, with appropriately reviewed youth participation if applicable. Months 10-12: polished web release and a bounded distribution pilot with libraries or youth organizations.

Cash-prize route and uncertainty

Payday Tides is submitted for Zoud GameLab's judged category prizes. A category prize is discretionary and subject to selection and winner checks. The $29,000 scenario above does not change the amount sought, does not assert that Zoud has offered funding, and would require a separate agreement before any work begins. The current playable build stands on its own.